

HAPPY Mother's Day

March Newsletter



Welcome Message



Understanding Defiance in Early Childhood: Turning Conflict into Connection

Dear Parents and Teachers,

Moments of defiance are something every adult caring for young children will encounter. A child refuses to put on their shoes, insists on doing something their own way, or reacts strongly when limits are set. While these situations can feel exhausting, it helps to remember that defiance in early childhood is often a sign of healthy development. It is part of how children learn independence, communication, and emotional expression.

Rather than viewing these moments as simple misbehavior, we can see them as opportunities to teach children how to navigate emotions, boundaries, and relationships.

Defiance Across the Early Years

Children's resistance evolves as they grow.

1-2 years:

At this stage, children are discovering their independence. Their "no" becomes a powerful tool to express themselves. Tantrums often appear because children feel big emotions but lack the language to communicate their needs clearly.

2-3 years:

Toddlers begin testing limits more intentionally. They want control over daily decisions and are learning that their choices matter. Defiance here often reflects a child's attempt to say, "I want to be involved in what happens to me."

3-5 years:

This is a particularly important stage. Preschoolers begin to understand rules, fairness, and relationships with others. They may question adults, negotiate, argue, or show strong emotional reactions. While challenging, this stage is incredibly valuable because it allows children to **learn negotiation, emotional understanding, and problem-solving**—skills that will support them throughout life.

Communicating in Moments of Conflict

A helpful guide for parents and educators is the approach described in the book **“How to Talk So Little Kids Will Listen and Listen So Little Kids Will Talk”** by Joanna Faber and Julie King. The authors offer simple communication strategies that reduce power struggles and help children cooperate while preserving their dignity.

Some of the key ideas include:

Acknowledge feelings before correcting behavior

Children calm down faster when they feel understood.

For example:

Instead of saying, *“Stop shouting. It’s time to leave.”*

Try: *“You really want to keep playing. It’s hard to leave when you’re having fun.”*

Recognizing a child’s feelings does not mean allowing inappropriate behavior—it simply shows them their emotions are seen.

Offer choices within clear limits

Children are more cooperative when they feel some control.

For example:

“You need to wear a jacket. Would you like the blue one or the green one?”

Use playfulness when possible

Young children respond well to imagination and humor.

For example:

“Let’s see if your shoes can jump onto your feet before I count to five!”

Invite problem solving

When children are calm, involve them in finding solutions.

“Yesterday it was hard to leave the playground. What can we do today to make leaving easier?”

These small shifts in communication help children feel respected while still learning to follow necessary boundaries.

Emotions, Vulnerability, and Learning

Another helpful perspective comes from researcher **Brené Brown**, whose work on emotional learning reminds us that emotions—especially difficult ones—are an essential part of human growth. Children need safe relationships where they can experience disappointment, frustration, and anger without feeling shame.

When adults respond calmly and acknowledge feelings, children learn that emotions are **not something to hide or fear**. Instead, they become signals that help us understand ourselves.

Teaching children to name and express emotions builds **emotional intelligence**, which research shows is strongly connected to resilience, empathy, and healthy relationships later in life.

Growing Emotionally Intelligent and Resilient Children

When parents and educators combine respectful communication with emotional awareness, powerful learning happens.

Children begin to understand that:

- Feelings are normal and manageable
- Conflicts can be solved through communication
- Boundaries exist to keep everyone safe and respected
- Their voice matters, but so do the needs of others

Through repeated experiences of being heard, guided, and supported, children gradually develop **self-regulation, empathy, and resilience**.

A Gentle Reminder for Adults

Supporting children through defiance requires patience. There will be moments when things do not go perfectly—and that is part of the learning process for adults as well.

What matters most is the ongoing relationship: the calm presence, the willingness to listen, and the effort to guide children rather than overpower them.

When we approach conflict as an opportunity to teach, we help children grow into individuals who can express themselves, respect others, and navigate challenges with confidence.

For Parents Who Would Like to Explore Further

Recommended Reading

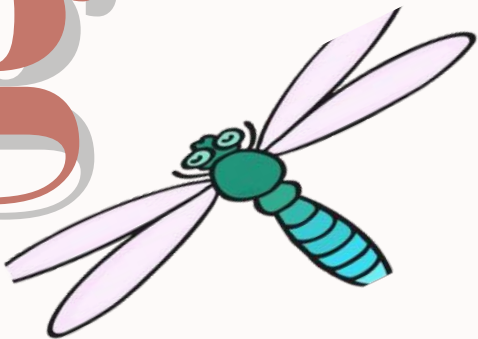
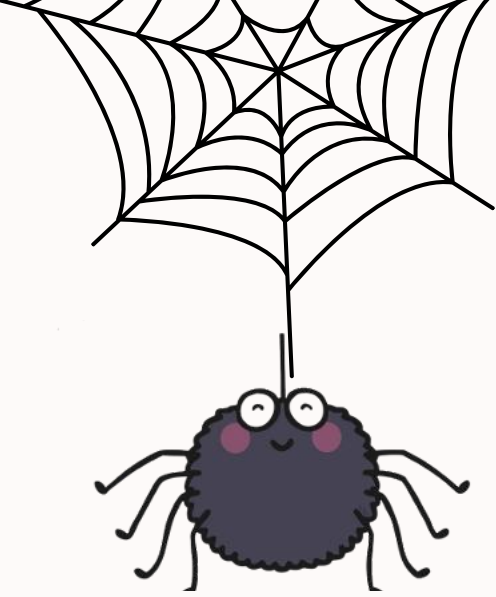
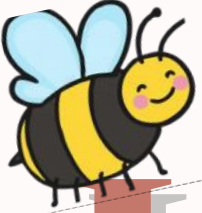
- *How to Talk So Little Kids Will Listen and Listen So Little Kids Will Talk* — Joanna Faber & Julie King
- *Rising Strong* — Brené Brown
- *Daring Greatly* — Brené Brown
- *The Whole-Brain Child* — Daniel J. Siegel & Tina Payne Bryson

These resources offer thoughtful insights into emotional development, communication, and raising resilient children.

With partnership and purpose,

Lamia Hassanin





Up-coming Events

Wednesday, 1st April -
Blue Day- **Student only**

Thursday, 2nd April -
Spring Bonnet Parade- **Student only**

Sunday, 5th April -
Palm Sunday- **Daycare Closed**

Thursday, 9th April -
Holy Thursday- **Daycare Closed**

Sunday, 12th April -
Eastern Easter- **Daycare Closed**

Monday, 13th April-
Sham el nesim- **Daycare Closed**





BUSY BUTTERFLIES

Teacher: Menna Ashraf

WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

The Butterflies class is excited to continue exploring the topic of the four seasons: Spring, Summer, Autumn, and Winter.

We have already started with the winter season, where the children learned about cold weather, winter clothes like hats and gloves, and enjoyed fun activities with ice and penguins.

We also had a lovely time celebrating Eid, where the children enjoyed making Kahk and had a wonderful, joyful experience.

We are currently working on our Mother's Day celebration. The children prepared simple gifts to express their love and appreciation.

We are also happy to celebrate this special day with our lovely mothers. It will be a warm and friendly day filled with beautiful moments.





BUSY BUTTERFLIES

Teacher: Menna Ashraf



UPCOMING THEME

The Butterflies class is excited to continue our journey through the four seasons as we move on to explore Spring and then Summer. During Spring, the children will learn about blooming flowers, green trees, butterflies, and the beautiful colors of nature. We will talk about how nature comes back to life and enjoy singing cheerful spring songs and exploring flowers through fun activities.

As we move into Summer, the children will discover sunny weather, beach fun, and exciting outdoor activities. We will also learn about summer clothes and simple ways to stay cool while enjoying the sunshine.

We are also very excited to celebrate Blue Day! It will be a joyful day full of fun, messy, and playful activities. We can't wait to see our little ones dressed in blue and ready to shine. In addition, we will celebrate Spring with a special party! The children will enjoy a fun garden egg hunt, searching for hidden eggs, singing happy spring songs, and sharing lots of smiles and laughter. We are super excited to see their adorable and creative hats!

We can't wait to create beautiful memories full of fun, laughter, and joy together.



PLAYLIST

[Spring Songs for Children - Spring is Here with Lyrics - Kids Songs by The Learning Station](#)



BUMBLE BEES

Teacher: Grace Muringani

WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

All Aboard the Transportation Adventure!

This month, our Busy Bees have been buzzing with excitement as we explored the fascinating world of transportation! From the simple joys of riding a car to the awe of imagining ourselves as captains of boats sailing across the waters, we have had so much fun learning about how people, goods, and animals get from one place to another.

Personal, Social & Emotional Development:

In our transportation theme, the Busy Bees have been developing their ability to express their preferences and interests. Whether it is choosing which vehicle to explore in our play area or expressing excitement about learning new things, our little learners have been showing more confidence in sharing their preferences of the cars they like.

Activity Highlight: The children took turns pretending to be passengers and drivers of various vehicles, helping them practice taking turns, sharing, and cooperating. This also gave them the opportunity to express their emotions about different modes of transport, such as excitement for the "rumbling train!"

Physical Development:

Transportation has also provided a great opportunity to build our physical skills! Our Busy Bees have been practicing hand-eye coordination and fine motor skills by engaging in activities such as using mark-making tools to draw and colour and decorate different vehicles.

Activity Highlight: The children enjoyed using printed numbers as roadways for toy cars, imitating to be drivers as they drove their vehicles through the road numbers.

Communication & Language:

Our transportation activities have introduced new words and helped the children improve their communication skills. The Busy Bees have enjoyed exploring transportation sounds, songs, and rhymes—from the "chu-chu" of a train to the "beep beep" of a car. They are also learning to follow longer instructions, like "Put your toys away and then we will read a book," which is helping their listening and understanding skills.



BUMBLE BEES

Teacher: Grace Muringani

WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

Activity Highlight: We introduced several transportation-related songs, which the children absolutely loved! These songs helped reinforce the different modes of transport and gave the children a chance to sing along and even act out the motions (like rowing our boats during circle time!).

Other news:

Not only have we been focusing on transportation, but our little ones have also been busy preparing for special events, such as the recently celebrated Mother's Day. Let me take this moment to wish all the mothers a belated Happy Mother's Day once again! In addition, we have been gearing up for some exciting upcoming events like Blue Day and Spring Day.





BUMBLE BEES

Teacher: Grace Muringani

UPCOMING THEME

Transportation

With all the above events taking place and forthcoming public holidays, we are extending our Transportation theme a little longer over the next few weeks with a special focus on Air Transportation, Emergency Vehicles, and Community Vehicles. Stay tuned for more fun learning ahead!

Thank you for your continued support and for being such an integral part of our learning journey. We look forward to sharing more updates with you in our next newsletter!



PLAYLIST



[Driving in my car](#)

[Aeroplane song](#)

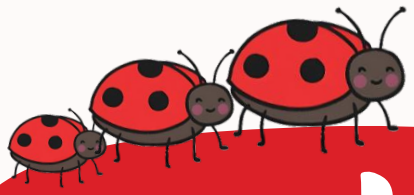
[10 little airplanes](#)

[things that go](#)

[Here comes the fire truck](#)

[Row Row Row your boat](#)





LUCKY LADYBIRDS

Teacher: Nahla Hassan

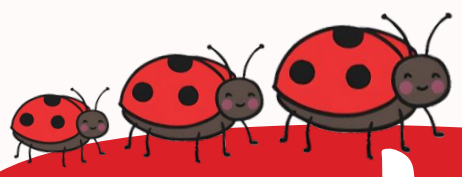
WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

We've been having a wild time exploring the "Kingdom of Animals". We started with "Down to the Farm", where we learned about farm animals like cows, pigs, and chickens. The kids discovered the sounds they make, their features, what they eat, and how they're useful to us (milk and eggs). We made farm-themed crafts, and sang animal songs.

Next, we snuggled up with "Paws, Claws & Whiskers", exploring different kinds of pets like dogs, cats, and rabbits. We talked about how to care for them, their funny behaviors, and how some are super helpful around the house. The kids loved sharing stories about their own pets (mostly imaginary ones :D).

We ended the month with "Into the Wild", learning about wild animals like lions, tigers, and bears. We discovered where they live, what they eat, and why they're best left in their natural habitats (no wild animals as pets, sorry).





LUCKY LADYBIRDS

Teacher: Nahla Hassan

UPCOMING THEME

We have some fun events coming up:

Blue Day, Spring Bonnet, and Easter celebrations.

More Animal Adventures

- "Life Under the Sea": Discovering ocean creatures like fish, octopus, crab, and dolphin, and their amazing underwater world
- "Arctic Explorers" : Learning about animals like polar bears, penguins, and seals, and how they adapt to the icy Arctic
- "Dinosaurs": We will explore different types, their habitats, and what they used to eat.



PLAYLIST



[Spring and Easter playlist](#)

[Dinosaurs playlist](#)

[Under the sea playlist](#)

[Mother's day playlist](#)

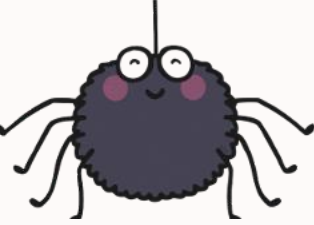




SPINNING SPIDERS

Teacher: Reem Taha

early
years
- THE DAYCARE -



WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

Over the past few weeks, the children have been exploring the fascinating world of dinosaurs! Through stories, role play, creative art, small world play, music, movement, and hands-on discovery, the children learned about different types of dinosaurs, their sizes, features, and habitats. They compared big and small dinosaurs, counted dinosaur eggs, explored footprints, and used new vocabulary such as roar, stomp, huge, tiny, herbivore, and carnivore.

The children also took part in imaginative play, creating dinosaur parks, going on "fossil hunts," and building habitats together. These activities encouraged teamwork, problem-solving, communication, and creativity.

We celebrated Ramadan and Eid with a special cooking session, making Kahk together. The children loved learning about the traditions and enjoyed creating and sharing these treats with their friends.

The children have been busy preparing special gifts for Mother's Day. We are excited to celebrate all the wonderful moms in the upcoming month!

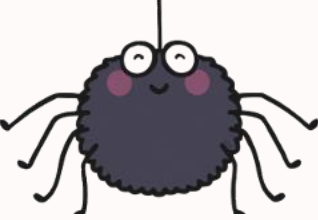
We reviewed what we've been learning in our literacy program, reinforcing recognising letters, their sounds and matching words and comprehension skills in fun and engaging ways.





SPINNING SPIDERS

Teacher: Reem Taha



UPCOMING THEME

Next month, we are excited to continue exploring our current theme and take part in seasonal and themed activities that encourage curiosity, creativity, and personal growth:

- **Spring & Easter Bonnet Parade:** The children will celebrate Spring by creating their own colorful Easter bonnets and participating in a festive parade, and enjoying eggs hunt with their friends.
- **Blue Day:** We are all matters; we will explore themes of diversity, kindness, and self-expression during Blue Day. Children will enjoy many messy activities while they practice empathy and reinforce the idea that everyone matters and contributes to our community.

The children will continue to enjoy hands-on, messy activities such as painting, sensory play, and craft projects. These experiences spark creativity, encourage problem-solving, and allow children to explore textures, colours, and materials in a fun, experimental way.

Skills We Will Be Focusing On Next Month

Personal & Social Development: playing cooperatively, talking about feelings, and learning how behaviour affects others

Communication & Language: following longer instructions, joining in repeated story phrases, and using new vocabulary

Physical Development: climbing, balancing, fine motor control, and practising good hygiene

Literacy: recognising and saying letter sounds (Jolly Phonics Set 1) and beginning to form letters

Mathematics: counting to 10, recognising numerals, comparing small groups, and exploring number composition

Understanding the World: celebrating Spring, Easter, Blue Day, and learning that We All Matter

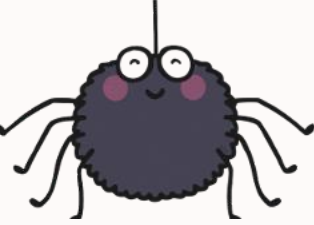
Expressive Arts: messy activities, creative storytelling, and imaginative play



SPINNING SPIDERS

Teacher: Reem Taha

early
years
- THE DAYCARE -



UPCOMING THEME

How You Can Support at Home

- Read dinosaur and Spring/Easter stories together and encourage your child to repeat key phrases
- Practise letter sounds and look for them in books or around the house
- Count toys, steps, or snacks together
- Encourage imaginative play (roaring, stomping, building habitats, creating messy art!)
- Talk about feelings and model kind, calm problem-solving

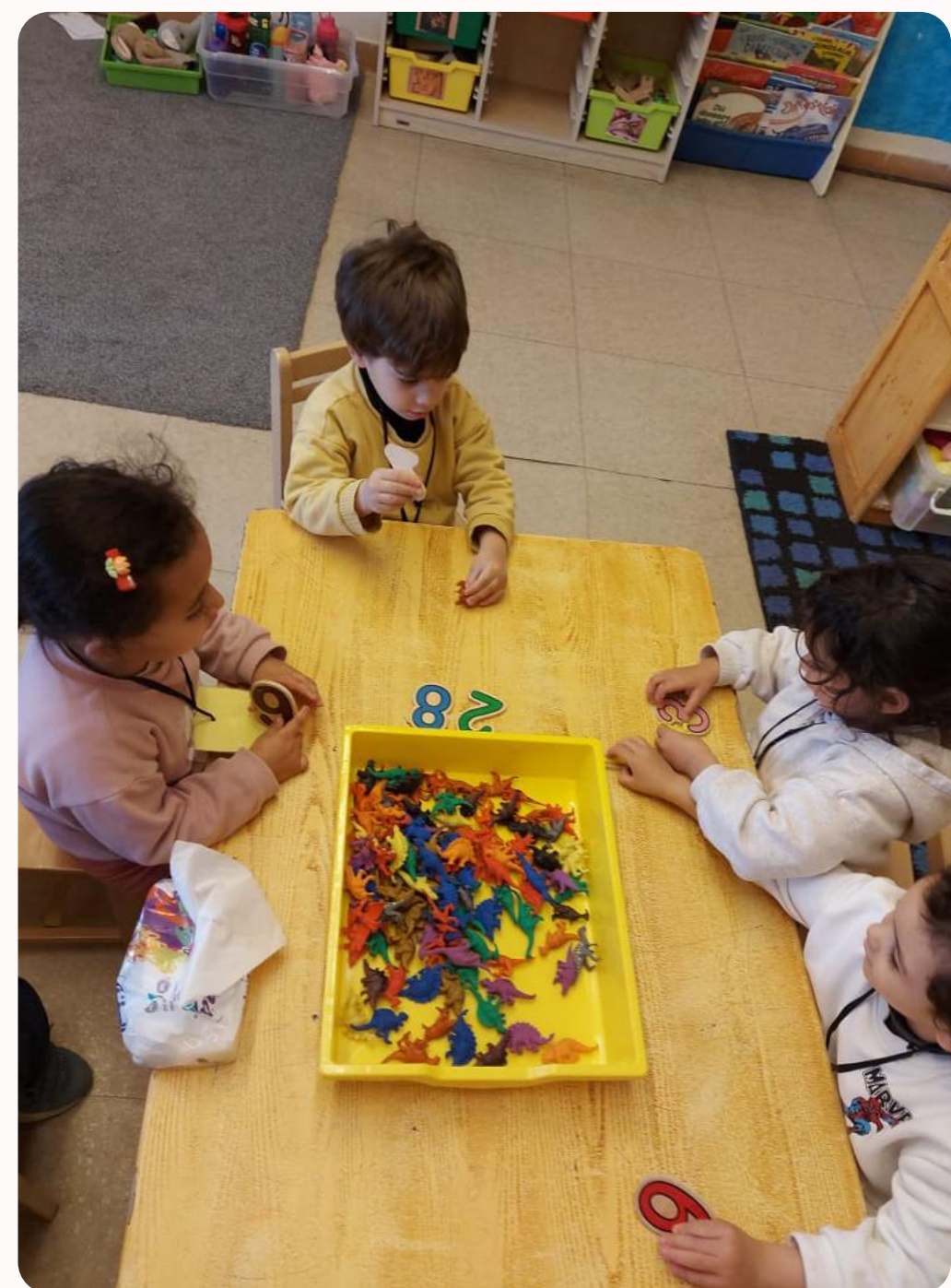
We look forward to another month filled with learning, laughter, and exciting celebrations

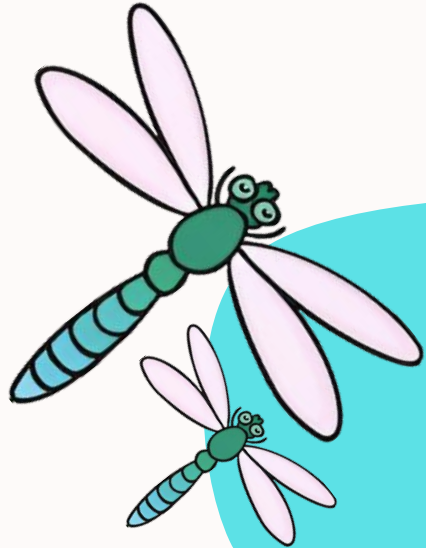


PLAYLIST

[There's A Dinosaur At My Door | Dinosaur Songs for Kids](#)

[Spring Songs for Children](#)





DREAMY DRAGONFLIES

Teacher: Nourhan Youssef

WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

This month, the Dragonflies have been exploring our exciting Garden theme! The children learned about the parts of a plant including roots, stem, leaves, and petals, and discussed the role of each part. For example, roots help the plant stay in the ground and absorb water, the stem supports the plant, leaves make food, and petals attract insects. We also explored what plants need to grow, such as sunlight, water, and air. The children enjoyed learning through songs and hand gestures, acting out the different parts of a plant in a fun and engaging way.

In addition, the children learned about the life cycle of a seed through visual activities and singing. They have also started preparing themselves to apply what they have learned in real-life situations.

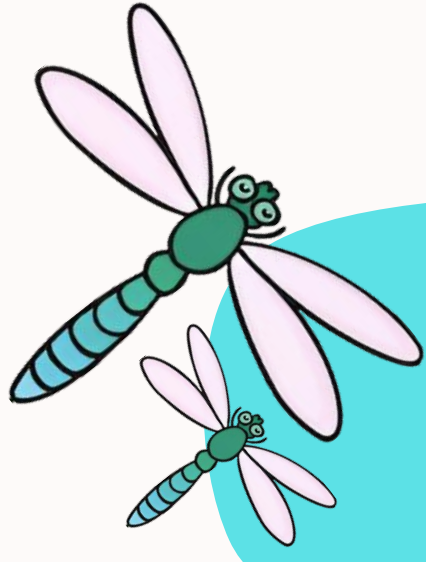
Alongside our theme, the children spent special time preparing for Mother's Day. They enjoyed making their Mother's Day cards with love and care, and practiced Mother's Day songs, which they were very excited to perform.

Communication & Language

Our main focus this month was helping children maintain attention, concentrate, and sit quietly during appropriate activities. During garden time, the children collected leaves, flowers, and natural materials, then used magnifying glasses to observe them closely. They were encouraged to sit calmly and focus on one item, noticing details such as color, shape, and tiny lines. Through guided questions and discussions, the children practiced expressing what they observed and listening to others.

Physical Development

In physical development, we focused on helping children begin to form recognizable letters. The children engaged in a variety of hands-on activities, including building letters using playdough and beads, tracing letters on large cards, and constructing letters using links. These activities supported their fine motor skills and early writing development in a fun and interactive way.



DREAMY DRAGONFLIES

Teacher: Nourhan Youssef

WHAT WE HAVE BEEN LEARNING

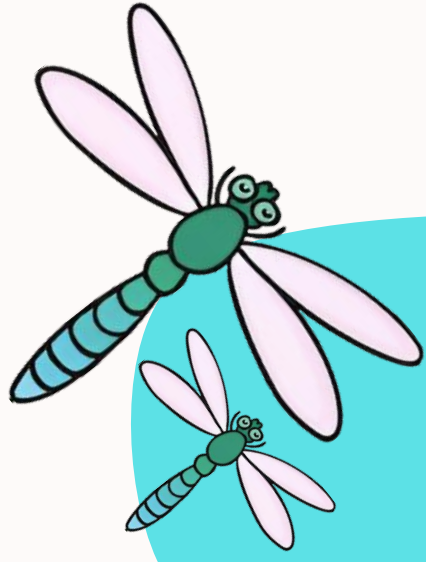
Literacy

In literacy, our focus was on helping children understand that information can be retrieved from books and computers. During circle time, we explored questions about plants and discussed how to find answers. The children learned to use books by looking at the cover, title, and pictures, and we also used the computer to search for information. Through both methods, they discovered that plants need water, sunlight, and soil to grow.

Mathematics

In mathematics, we focused on helping children recognize numerals that are meaningful to them. The children explored numbers through activities such as counting the letters in their names, discussing numbers they see in their daily lives, and coloring their favorite numbers. These activities helped them connect numbers to their personal experiences.





DREAMY DRAGONFLIES

Teacher: Nourhan Youssef

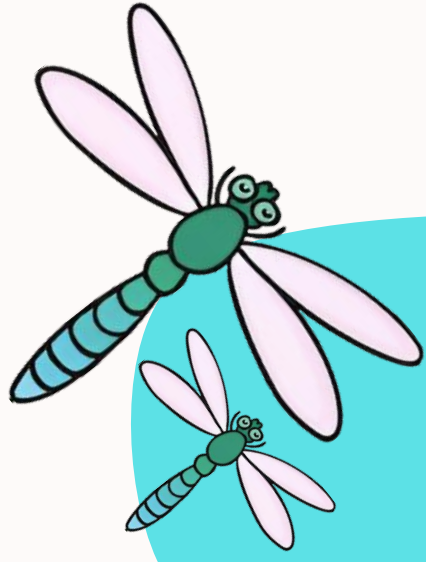
UPCOMING THEME

Next month, the Dragonflies will continue exploring the Garden theme, with a greater focus on applying what they have learned. The children will have hands-on experiences planting seeds, vegetables, chia seeds, and other plants based on their own choices. They will observe the growth process over time and begin to understand how to care for living things.

We will also be learning about spring weather, discussing how flowers bloom and how the environment becomes more colorful and lively during this season.

The children are also looking forward to several special events. We will be celebrating with an Easter Parade and Egg Hunt, where children will design and create their own Easter hats. In addition, we will have a Blue Day, where children will take part in a variety of sensory and messy play activities using the color blue. This experience will support an inclusive environment where all children can explore materials in their own way and at their own pace, while promoting sharing, cooperation, and respect for others.





DREAMY DRAGONFLIES

Teacher: Nourhan Youssef

UPCOMING THEME

Communication & Language

Our focus will be on helping children link their statements and stay on a main theme or intention. Through discussions, storytelling, and describing their planting experiences, children will be encouraged to express their ideas clearly while maintaining focus on the topic.

Physical Development

In physical development, we will focus on helping children use a pencil effectively to form recognizable letters, with most letters correctly formed. Activities will support pencil control and fine motor skills through structured writing and creative tasks.

Literacy

In literacy, the children will practice writing their own names and simple words such as labels and captions. They will be encouraged to write during activities, for example by labeling their plants or adding captions to their work.

Mathematics

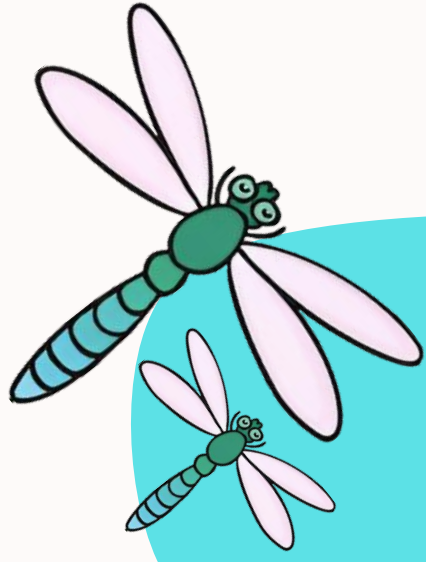
In mathematics, we will focus on helping children order two items by weight or capacity. Through practical activities, children will compare objects and begin to understand concepts such as heavier and lighter, and full and empty.

Knowledge & Understanding of the World

Children will be encouraged to talk about what they observe in their environment, including plants, animals, and natural or found objects. Through planting and observation, they will develop curiosity and a deeper understanding of the world around them.

Expressive Arts & Design

In expressive arts, children will explore how different materials and media can be combined to create new effects. This will be linked to activities such as messy play, color exploration, and designing their Easter hats.



DREAMY DRAGONFLIES

Teacher: Nourhan Youssef

PLAYLIST

[Farmer Plants the Seeds](#)

[The Seed Song](#)

[The Tiny Seed Song](#)

["The Flower Song"](#)

[Five Little Flowers](#)

[The Planting Song - Earth Day Song](#)

[Out in the wood](#)

[Can You Plant a Bean](#)

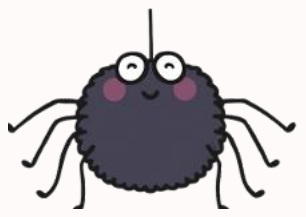
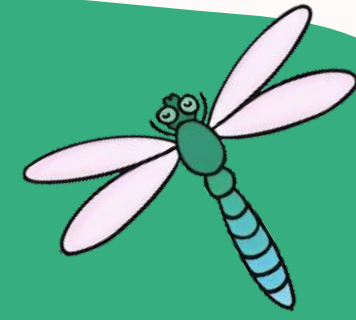
[There's Something in My Garden](#)

[Roots, Stem, Leaves, Flower](#)

[I Love The Mountains](#)

[Spring Songs for Children](#)





اللغة العربية

Teacher: Randa Ali

ماذا تعلمنا

مَوْضُوعُ هَذَا الشَّهْرِ: حَرْفَا الثَّاءِ (ث) وَالْجِيمِ (ج) + قِصَصٌ وَنَشَاطَاتٌ

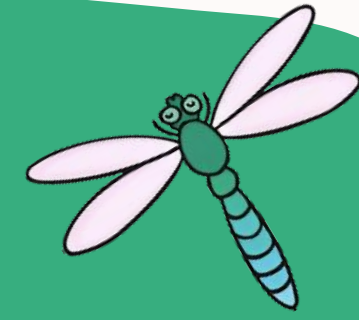
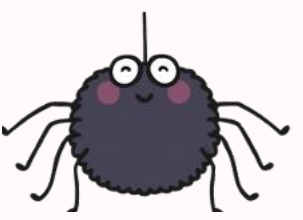
أَقْضَيْنَا شَهْرًا مُمْتِعًا مَلِيًّا بِالتَّعَلُّمِ وَالْاِكْتِشَافِ! تَعَرَّفَ أَطْفَالُنَا عَلَى حَرْفِي الثَّاءِ (ث) وَالْجِيمِ (ج)، وَاسْتَمْتَعُوا بِقِصَصٍ جَدِيدَةٍ أَعْطَتْهُمْ فُرْصًا لِلتَّفَاعُلِ وَتَعَلُّمِ الْقِيَمِ وَالنِّظَامِ.

الأهداف التعليمية:

- أَنْ يَتَعَرَّفَ الطِّفْلُ عَلَى شَكْلِ حَرْفِي الثَّاءِ وَالْجِيمِ فِي أَوَّلِ الْكَلِمَةِ وَوَسْطِهَا وَآخِرَهَا.
- أَنْ يَنْطِقَ الطِّفْلُ صَوْتَ الْحَرْفَيْنِ نُطْقًا صَحِيحًا.
- أَنْ يَرْبِطَ الطِّفْلُ الْحَرْفَ بِكَلِمَاتٍ تَبْدَأُ بِهِ.
- أَنْ يُمَيِّزَ الطِّفْلُ بَيْنَ الْحَرْفَيْنِ وَبَاقِي الْحُرُوفِ.
- غَرْسُ قِيَمِ التَّفَاعُلِ وَالنِّظَامِ وَالْاِحْتِرَامِ مِنْ خِلَالِ الْقِصَصِ
- **كَلِمَاتُ حَرْفِ الثَّاءِ (ث): ثَوْب - ثَلَاجَة - ثَوْم - ثِمَار - ثَعْبَان**
- **كَلِمَاتُ حَرْفِ الْجِيمِ (ج): جُنْدِي - جَمَل - جَرَس - جُبْن**
- **الْقِصَصُ الَّتِي قَرَأْنَاهَا:**
- **أَخِي أَجْدِيدٌ فِي الْبَيْتِ:** قِصَّةٌ تَهْدَفُ إِلَى اسْتِقْبَالِ الطِّفْلِ الْجَدِيدِ وَتَعَلُّمِهِ كَيْفَ يَشَارِكُ وَيَشْعُرُ بِالانْتِمَاءِ دُونَ الْغِيَرَةِ.

أَنَا يَرْقَانَهُ: قِصَّةٌ تَعَلِّمُ الْأَطْفَالَ النِّظَامَ وَالتَّرْتِيبَ فِي حَيَاتِهِمُ الْيَوْمِيَّةِ.

و"نظرًا للتغيرات الجوية، تم توضيح لأطفالنا ما يحدث في الأحوال الجوية، وتحدثنا عن دَوْرَةِ الْمَطَرِ: تَكَلَّمَ الْأَطْفَالُ عَنْ كَيْفِيَّةِ صُعُودِ الْمَاءِ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ بَعْدَ تَبَخُّرِهِ مِنَ الشَّمْسِ، وَكَيْفِيَّةِ عَوْدَتِهِ إِلَى الْأَرْضِ عَلَى شَكْلِ مَطَرٍ. فَهَمَّ الْأَطْفَالُ أَنَّهُ عِنْدَ اصْطِدَامِ الْغُيُومِ بِبَعْضِهَا يَتَكَوَّنُ الْمَطَرُ وَيَنْزِلُ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ، وَتَفَاجَّأُوا بِهَذِهِ الظَّاهِرَةِ الطَّبِيعِيَّةِ الرَّائِعَةِ!



اللغة العربية

Teacher: Randa Ali

الاجانى:

اغنية ايام الاسبوع

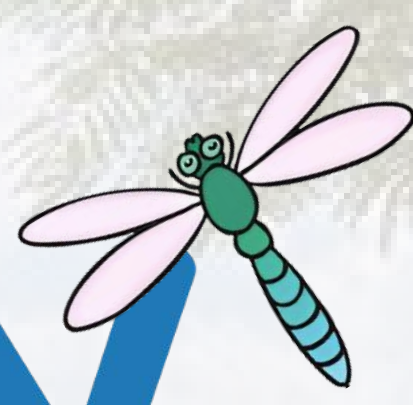
أغنية دق الباب للحروف

أغنية الخضراوات



MOTHER'S DAY EVENT





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